

AI EXPLAIN IT SIMPLY KIT

A calm guide to understanding confusing information
with AI, without feeling overwhelmed.

WHAT THIS KIT HELPS WITH

Letters, bills, forms, online articles and jargon-heavy information. It gives you simple words to use when you want a clearer explanation and a sensible next step.

*You do not need to be technical. You do not need to know the right words.
You only need a little curiosity and a few minutes.*

Start here

Confusing information can make anyone feel stuck. A long letter, an unfamiliar bill or an online article full of jargon can leave you wondering: What does this actually mean? What matters? What should I do next?

AI can help you slow it down and put it into plain English. This kit gives you safe, simple ways to ask for that help.

A small reassurance

You are not asking AI to make important decisions for you. You are using it as a helpful first reader - to explain, organise and point out what may need your attention.

How to use the prompts

1. Open ChatGPT or the AI tool you normally use.
2. Copy a prompt from this guide and paste it in.
3. Paste the part of the letter, bill, form or article you want explained. Remove names, account numbers, addresses and other private details first.
4. Read the answer slowly. Ask a follow-up question if you would like it shorter, clearer or more specific.

Before you paste anything

Do not share passwords, bank details, full account numbers, medical records, National Insurance numbers, private addresses or anything you would not want stored online.

A sensible rule

For anything involving money, health, legal rights, benefits, deadlines or safety, use AI to understand the information - then check important details with the organisation, a qualified professional or a trusted official source.

The "Explain It Simply" prompt set

Use these prompts exactly as they are, or change a few words to fit your situation. You do not have to make them perfect.

1. Explain this in plain English

Use this when: a letter, email or paragraph feels hard to follow.

Copy and paste this into ChatGPT:

Please explain the text below in plain English, as if you were explaining it to a friend. Keep it clear and do not leave out anything important.

[Paste the text here]

2. Give me the short version

Use this when: the information is long and you want the main point first.

Copy and paste this into ChatGPT:

Please give me a short, plain-English summary of this. Then list the three most important things I need to know.

[Paste the text here]

A gentle next step: If it is still too long, ask: "Could you make that even shorter?"

3. Translate the jargon

Use this when: you understand some of the words, but not the technical language.

Copy and paste this into ChatGPT:

Please pick out any difficult, technical or official words in this text. Explain each one in simple everyday language.

[Paste the text here]

4. Tell me what matters

Use this when: you need help separating important details from background information.

Copy and paste this into ChatGPT:

Please explain what matters most in this information. Put the important points in a short list and tell me if there are any dates, amounts or actions I should pay attention to.

[Paste the text here]

If the first answer is not quite right

You do not need to start again. Try one of these simple follow-up questions:

Could you say that in even simpler language?

Could you put that into a short checklist?

Which part should I check with the original organisation?

The "Explain It Simply" prompt set

5. What do I need to do next?

Use this when: you have understood the words but want a practical next step.

Copy and paste this into ChatGPT:

Based on this information, what are the possible next steps? Please keep the answer practical and put the steps in the order I might do them. If there is a deadline, point it out.

[Paste the text here]

6. What questions should I ask?

Use this when: you need to call, email or speak to an organisation but are not sure what to say.

Copy and paste this into ChatGPT:

Please help me prepare a short list of clear questions to ask about this information. Keep the questions polite and easy to understand.

[Paste the text here]

7. Explain both sides of a claim

Use this when: you have read an online claim or article and want a balanced view.

Copy and paste this into ChatGPT:

Please explain the main claim in this article in plain English. Then tell me what information I would need to check before deciding whether to trust it. Do not guess if the article does not provide enough evidence.

[Paste the text here]

8. Help me check the source

Use this when: you are not sure whether an online article, post or offer is trustworthy.

Copy and paste this into ChatGPT:

Please give me a simple checklist for checking whether this source is trustworthy. Look for who wrote it, when it was published, what evidence it gives and whether it is trying to sell me something.

[Paste the text here]

A calm way to check something important

First, ask for a simple explanation. Next, ask what needs checking. Finally, look for the key point on an official source or contact the organisation directly. Taking it one step at a time is enough.

The "Explain It Simply" prompt set

9. Help me understand this form

Use this when: a form asks for information that is unclear.

Copy and paste this into ChatGPT:

Please explain each question in this form in plain English. Tell me what each question appears to be asking for. Do not tell me what answer to give if it depends on my personal situation.

[Paste the relevant questions here]

10. Talk me through it step by step

Use this when: you feel overwhelmed and need to take one thing at a time.

Copy and paste this into ChatGPT:

I feel overwhelmed by this information. Please break it into small steps. Start by telling me the first thing to understand, then the next thing to check, and finally any question I may need to ask someone.

[Paste the text here]

Three calm walkthroughs

These examples show a gentle way to use AI as a first reader. Change the wording to suit your own situation.

1. A letter that feels official or confusing

- Remove personal details, reference numbers and addresses.
- Paste the important paragraphs into ChatGPT.
- Start with Prompt 1, then use Prompt 4 to spot dates, amounts or actions.
- If it affects a deadline, money, benefits, legal rights or health, confirm the important points with the sender or a qualified person.

2. A bill or statement

- Paste only the headings and figures you want explained - never account numbers, card details or passwords.
- Ask: "Please explain these charges in plain English and list the amounts I should check."
- If something looks unexpected, contact the company through a phone number or website you found independently.

3. An article or online claim

- Ask for a short plain-English summary first.
- Then use Prompt 7 or 8 to see what needs checking.
- For health, money, legal or safety claims, look for a reliable official source before acting.

Remember

A clear explanation can help you feel calmer. It is not the same as professional advice or proof that something is true.

The "What should I check?" checklist

When information feels important, slow down. These questions can help you decide what deserves a closer look.

- Who sent or published this? Is it an organisation, an expert, a news outlet or an unknown source?
- When was it written? Could the information be out of date?
- Is there a deadline, charge, consequence or request for personal information?
- Does it explain where its facts came from, or does it only make a strong claim?
- Is it trying to make me act quickly, feel frightened or buy something?
- Could I check the key point on an official website or by contacting the organisation directly?
- Would it help to ask a trusted person or qualified professional before I act?

A useful prompt for important information

What parts of this should I check with the original organisation or an official source before I make a decision? Please explain why each one matters.

When to pause and get human help

Pause if the information involves an urgent deadline, a large payment, a legal dispute, a medical decision, safety, a suspected scam or a request for sensitive details. AI can help you prepare questions, but it should not be the final word.

Your step-by-step understanding template

Use this page whenever you are faced with something confusing. You can write your answers down first, then turn them into a clear question for AI.

1. What am I looking at?

A letter, bill, form, article, email, offer or something else?

2. What is confusing me?

A word, a sentence, the overall meaning, a charge, a deadline or what to do next?

3. What do I need from the answer?

A simple explanation, a summary, a list of actions, questions to ask, or things to check?

4. What should I keep private?

Remove names, account details, addresses, passwords and other personal information before pasting anything.

5. What might need checking?

Anything involving money, health, legal rights, benefits, deadlines, safety or an unexpected request.

Put it together

YOUR OWN QUESTION

Please explain the information below in plain English. I am mainly confused about [write what is confusing]. I would like to understand [write what you need]. Please point out anything I should check or ask someone about.

[Paste the information here after removing private details]

You do not have to understand everything at once

When something feels confusing, the aim is not to become an expert overnight. It is simply to make the next small part clearer.

Use a prompt. Ask for plain English. Ask what matters. Ask what to check. Then take the next step that feels sensible.

Keep this guide nearby

Come back to it whenever a letter, bill, form or article leaves you feeling unsure. The more often you use it, the easier it becomes to ask for the explanation you need.

Clearer information. Calmer next steps.